you do what you feel like.' Yet he also inquired as to whether Headley had carried out surveillance in Denmark that Lashkar could use.[84] It appears that, having resigned himself to the fact that Headley could not be controlled, Sajid opportunistically sought to make use of his unsanctioned efforts. But Lashkar also continued to prioritize another attack against India–in his correspondence Sajid alerted Headley to the fact that Lakhvi and Seed had cleared his trip there.[85] It is not insignificant that the former was in prison and the latter under house arrest at the time.

Headley also remained opportunistic, as did Abdur Rehman who by summer's end had been released from jail. The latter lost contact with Kashmiri, who was believed to have been killed by a US drone strike.[86] Records of the communications that followed reveal that Headley suggested that, in light of Kashmiri's apparent death, Syed should reach out to Sajid Mir and re-solicit Lashkar's support. Neither held the group's leadership in the highest esteem. Headley complained they were perpetually focused on India, had 'rotten guts' and were too risk averse, to which Syed agreed, saying 'They do not want to take risk and [yet] they want to be praised also.' Nevertheless, in a separate coded conversation with his friend Tahawwur Hussain Rana, Headley made clear that what he wanted most was to carry through with the operation: 'I don't care that if I am working for Microsoft or I am working for a …any…GE or Philips. I don't care. As long as I am making money, I don't give a shit.'[87] In other words, he would work with whoever helped him, whether it was Kashmiri or Lashkar. Such a decision never became necessary. On 30 September Syed reported that Kashmiri was alive. Headley stated that he would return to Pakistan in early October to meet with both of them. US authorities arrested him three days later at O'Hare Airport in Chicago. He had approximately thirteen surveillance videos in his possession.[88] Soon after detaining Headley, US authorities arrested Rana as well and later indicted him for his alleged role in the Danish plot and the Mumbai attacks.[89] He pleaded not guilty and was awaiting trial at the time this book went to press. The US government also indicted both Syed and Kashmiri, though neither was in American custody at the time of writing.

A month later, police in Bangladesh took three men into custody.[90] Two of them were Indian nationals and all three confessed to being Lashkar operatives. Local authorities alleged they were planning attacks on the US